School of Computing Sciences

MODULE:	CMP-7027X Dissertation, CMP-7039X Dissertation P/T
ASSIGNMENT TITLE:	Dissertation report and presentation
SET BY:	Vincent Moulton – v.moulton@uea.ac.uk
CHECKED BY:	Ben Milner – b.milner@uea.ac.uk
DATE SET:	13th May 2026
VALUE:	70% (report) + 20% (presentation)
DUE DATE:	Report submission due Thursday, 20th August 2026
RETURN DATE:	Depends on date for presentation
SUBMISSION:	Blackboard

LEARNING OUTCOMES

Knowledge – you will be able to demonstrate detailed knowledge and understanding of a specific area within computing science

Technical - you will be able to design, implement and evaluate a computing or data science system

Independent learning – you will be able to undertake self-directed study that demonstrates your independent learning abilities

Communication – you will be able to write concise technical documents and demonstrate effective oral communication skills

Professionalism – you will be able to plan a project and monitor progress and work within a professional environment

SPECIFICATION

Overview

The aim of this assessment is to present the work done in the dissertation in the form of both a technical report and an oral presentation. The presentation is directly followed by a viva-style discussion of the work undertaken.

Description

The technical report, presentation and viva are all underpinned by the same technical work that has been done in the dissertation, but they represent three different ways of conveying that information. There are many different dissertation topics, ranging from systems development to data analysis, to app development, and so on. Therefore, there is no single report structure that is suitable for every type of dissertation, and so this assessment sheet does not attempt to impose a single structure.

Instead, there are certain elements that should be included in all dissertation reports, and these include an introduction, literature review, design, implementation, evaluation, conclusion and further work.

Deliverables

There are three parts to this assessment.

1. ***Report*** – the report should be written in either LaTeX or Word, using the provided templates, *but must be submitted as a PDF document*. Submission is through Blackboard. *The PDF file name should be of the form "student number-dissertation"* (e.g. 123456789-dissertation).

   The format of the report is as follows (you should follow the style in the provided templates; do *not* include any further information, such as a list of figures/tables or the names of the markers):

Description	*Number of pages*
Title	1 page (no more than 200 words)
Abstract	1 page (no more than 200 words)
Acknowledgement	1 page (no more than 200 words)
Statement of AI usage	1 page (no more than 200 words)
Core material (including Table of Contents and Appendices, if any)	No more than 40 pages
Bibliography	No limit

2. ***Presentation*** – the presentation should cover material similar to that in the report but also gives an opportunity to demonstrate practical work done. For example, showing how a system works, presenting your code (which you might be asked to provide for additional inspection), demonstrating a website or application, or showing the results of some data analysis. After the presentation, questions will follow. The presentation and questions should take no longer than 20 minutes.
3. ***Viva*** – directly following the presentation is the viva. This is where the two examiners will discuss with you the work you have done, for example asking you to explain or clarify parts of your report, to justify design decisions, or to explain results more fully. This should take no longer than 20 minutes *(in particular, the presentation and viva together should take no longer than 45 minutes).*

The submission date for the dissertation is Thursday 20th August 2026. There is no set date for the presentation and viva. The date should be agreed directly with the two markers and should take place by Friday, 11th September 2026.

Resources

Project discussions in supervisory group meetings

Relevant literature

Dissertation briefing slides

Marking scheme

The dissertation is marked by two people, the supervisor and a second marker. Both will assess independently and then agree on the final marks. The report and presentation both carry marks, but not the viva. As explained above, the viva is used for clarification and discussion. *The outcomes of the viva will be reflected in the marks awarded for the report.*

The report and presentation components are marked separately but are both underpinned by the same work that has been carried out on the dissertation. The marking for the report is based largely on the work done while the presentation marks are for how this work is presented, any demonstrations, and on question answering. The viva-style discussion after the presentation is aimed at supporting the individual elements in the report.

Report (70%)

Element	Weight	Description
Introduction	10%	• Broad background to the topic area and project • Motivation for why the work is significant and its application • Explicit statement of the aim and objectives
Literature review	10%	• Demonstration of comprehensive subject understanding, particularly with relevance to dissertation aim and objectives • Critical analysis of relevant literature
Preparation and design	30%	*Varies according to dissertation topic, and may include:* • Gathering and preparation of data • Explanation and justification of methods, models, technologies • Design, for example of software, a survey, hardware, algorithms • Experimental plan
Implementation and evaluation	30%	*Varies according to dissertation topic, and may include:* • Development of programming code and description of architecture using for example (UML) diagrams and algorithms • Experimental testing, user testing, software testing results: • Analysis of results by discussing experimental and/or test findings in depth. • Comparison against other studies and/or benchmarks, highlighting limitations and scope for improvement
Conclusion	10%	• Summary of the main findings, outcomes and results • Conclusion of the work achieved that consider the aim and objectives set out at the start • Suggestions for potential future work that are well-justified and could be done given necessary time and resources
Quality of written report	10%	• Logical structure and organisation of material into numbered chapters/sections • Clear and unambiguous technical writing style • Numbered figures and tables with appropriate captions and reference to figure or table in text • Correctly formatted references

Presentation (20%)

Element	Weight	Description
Quality of slides	40%	• Visual clarity of slides • Use of diagrams, illustrations, graphs as opposed to text where possible • Logical structure to presentation
Oral presentation	40%	• Clarity of oral delivery • Confidence of presentation • Engaging presentation that maintains the interest of the audience
Targeted question answering	20%	• Effective answering of questions that show solid understanding

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- what is meant by the terms 'plagiarism', 'collusion', and 'contract cheating'
- how to avoid plagiarism, collusion, and contract cheating
- using a proof reader
- what will happen if we suspect that you have breached the policy.

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